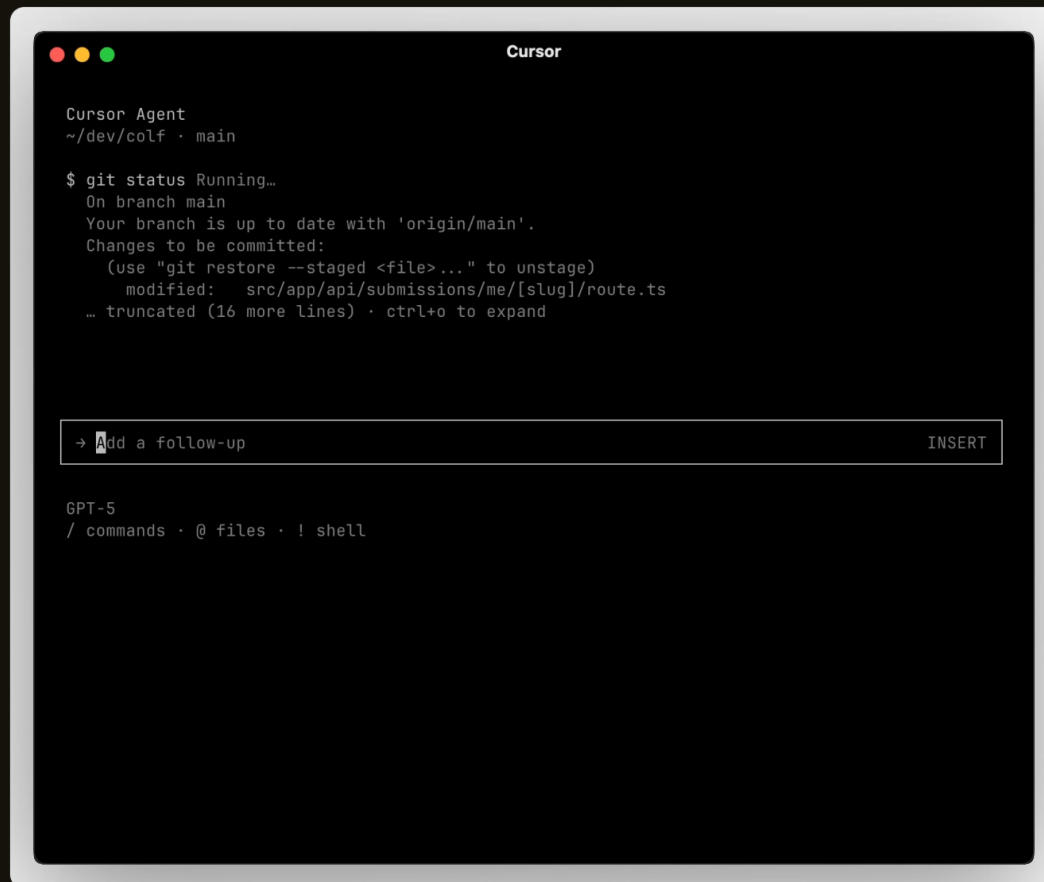


CLI

Shell Mode

Shell Mode runs shell commands directly from the CLI without leaving your conversation. Use it for quick, non-interactive commands with safety checks and output displayed in the conversation.



```
Cursor Agent
~/dev/colf · main

$ git status Running...
On branch main
Your branch is up to date with 'origin/main'.
Changes to be committed:
  (use "git restore --staged <file>..." to unstage)
    modified:   src/app/api/submissions/me/[slug]/route.ts
... truncated (16 more lines) · ctrl+o to expand

→ Add a follow-up INSERT

GPT-5
/ commands · @ files · ! shell
```

Command execution

Commands run in your login shell (`$SHELL`) with the CLI's working directory and environment. Chain commands to run in other directories:

```
cd subdir && npm test
```

Output

Large outputs are truncated automatically and long-running processes timeout to maintain performance.

Limitations

- Commands timeout after 30 seconds
- Long-running processes, servers, and interactive prompts are not supported
- Use short, non-interactive commands for best results

Permissions

Permissions

Commands are checked against your permissions and team settings before execution. See [Permissions](#) for detailed configuration.

Admin policies may block certain commands, and commands with redirection cannot be allowlisted inline.

Usage guidelines

Shell Mode works well for status checks, quick builds, file operations, and environment inspection.

Avoid long-running servers, interactive applications, and commands requiring input.

Each command runs independently - use `cd <dir> && ...` to run commands in other directories.

Troubleshooting

- If a command hangs, cancel with `Ctrl+C` and add non-interactive flags
- When prompted for permissions, approve once or add to allowlist with `Tab`
- For truncated output, use `Ctrl+O` to expand
- To run in different directories, use `cd <dir> && ...` since changes don't persist
- Shell Mode supports zsh and bash from your `$SHELL` variable

FAQ

Does `cd` persist across runs?



Can I change the timeout?



Where are permissions configured?



How do I exit Shell Mode?



English

